EasySLR Decision Brief

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We should spend the three discovery calls on Pharmacoevidence, Source Health Economics and ICON Health Economics, with Pharmacoevidence as the one-call pick.

1. Segment

We chose HEOR and SLR service providers: consultancies that run systematic literature reviews (SLRs) for pharma and health technology submissions.

- **Problem:** screening and data extraction in SLRs are slow and labor-heavy. An AI-assisted platform could cut that time.
- **Users:** SLR project leads, HEOR managers and research associates who do screening.
- **Approvers:** practice operations heads. In larger groups, group procurement or IT and security review.
- **Alternative rejected:** pharma in-house HEOR teams. They may offer larger volume, but procurement and security reviews are likely slower. This is our judgement and we did not research it.

2. Top three

1. Pharmacoevidence (Mohali, India). SLRs and meta-analysis are core work, with 22 to 26 India-based staff, founded 2020. Review efficiency matters to their delivery. Why now: their own AI/ML tool was used as a secondary screener in a NICE UK submission (November 2025 poster). Strongest reason we could be wrong: they already build their own AI tool, so they may not need an outside platform. First question: "Do you use or evaluate any third-party SLR platform for projects your in-house tool does not cover?"

2. Source Health Economics (Oxford, UK). Health economics, SLR and HTA services, about 33 staff, offices in Oxford and London. Review volume is not found. Why now: it was sold to SCIRIS in a Waterland-backed deal, so tool choices may be changing. Strongest reason we could be wrong: tool decisions may now sit with SCIRIS, not Source. First question: "After the SCIRIS deal, who chooses the review software for your team?"

3. ICON Health Economics (ICON plc, UK and US). The weakest of the three. The tool also says Research more, so we would gather hiring or volume evidence before booking a call. It has two Verified facts, one from an expired job post for an SLR-focused health economist. Why now: no live SLR vacancy is confirmed. Strongest reason we could be

wrong: a large CRO's procurement and security review would likely slow a pilot. First question: "Is your SLR reviewer team still hiring, and how many reviews does it deliver a year?"

3. Deferred and excluded

- **Costello Medical: Defer.** Already built its own screening application and tested AI-generated PICOS summaries.
- **Maven: Research more.** Legal entity and headcount not confirmed. Its site claims proprietary AI/ML tools, so in-house tooling is possible.
- **Evalueserve: Exclude.** Sells LitVerse, a competing living-SLR platform.

4. Changed or incomplete evidence

Source Health Economics was sold to SCIRIS, a Waterland-backed group with over 300 employees. The Clearwater transaction page confirms the sale but not its date. We had assumed Source was a small independent firm. That assumption was wrong, so we kept Source in the top three but recorded that buying decisions may now sit at group level. The discovery call should test that first. The rule engine still suggests a call, and the account is flagged for human review because of this uncertainty.

5. One-call pick

Pharmacoevidence. The rule engine suggests Defer because of its in-house AI tool. We overrode that to a discovery call, with a written reason: to test whether they would use an external platform for review types their tool does not cover, or act as a channel for EasySLR.

This override is the weakest judgement in the brief. If they rule out third-party tools, switch the call to Source Health Economics. New information that would change our choice: evidence that they have no appetite for external tools, or that SCIRIS controls Source's tooling completely.

6. Outreach and discovery

Outreach draft (not to be sent; the assignment asks for drafts only):

> Hi ,
>
> I'm researching how SLR teams handle screening and extraction in health economics work, and your team's published work caught my attention. I'm exploring whether a tool that supports SLR screening and extraction would be useful for a group that already runs its own AI, such as yours.
>
> Would you be open to a 20-minute call next week to hear how your team currently handles review tooling? I'd come with specific questions, not a pitch.
>
> Best regards, Harsh Singh

Three discovery questions:

1. Which review tools do you use today, and for which review types does your in-house tool fall short? If the answer is none, an external platform is unlikely to help.
2. Would you evaluate a third-party platform alongside your own tool, or only as a partner or channel?
3. Who decides on review software, and do group or client contracts limit the choice?

7. One-day pilot

Only if discovery confirms the need. Sized to one engineering day:

- **Morning, setup and data:** create a workspace for one live or recent SLR. Import its reference list. The import format needs confirming with EasySLR.
- **Afternoon, workflow:** agree screening criteria with the team. Run about 100 records side by side with the team's current method, and log time per record and agreement with the team's decisions.

Success measure (placeholder, to agree with the team): screening time per record falls by at least 20% on the sample, and agreement with the team's own decisions is at least 90%, judged by the team's lead.